

We have three different types of society, based on different values.

The first model is the society founded on archetype. It comes from the Greek word "arche", a founding and governing principle. A God and transcending entity that orders society according to his laws. We await from God the salvation, relying on the "arche".

This is the traditional society.

The second type of society is the one based on the prototype. To introduce this type of society, we have to say that Nietzsche wrote in his famous opera "Gott ist tot" ("God is dead"). This phrase encapsulate the motto of the society of prototypes, which no longer awaits salvation from providence, rather it provides for itself through technology. My needs are no longer entrusted to divine providence, passing from being a creature to a creature, becoming God. Protos means "first". Since God is dead, we are our own fathers. The death of God marks a transformation in the human way of looking at things, no longer poetically contemplative, but in a technical/manipulative one. If God dies, his laws and limits also die. If I have to provide for myself, then rules will be mine, and limits will be only those I impose on myself. If there is no principle to tell me that I cannot ethically/technically do what I can do, then the dominant value become the constant overcoming of the limit. The limit does not longer exist.

Ethics, in this context, becomes patetics.

We can therefore find the third model, given by societies founded on stereotype. This is the society inhabiting the net. What is a stereotype? The word "stereos" means rigid, while "type" means images. In typography, stereotype is a printing method that fixes through a rigid composition, creating a regular writing. In psychology, it's an approximation about a root that is not grounded in the real experience, but in beliefs absorbed by the families, schools, that are based not on what we have lived, but what is said, so the language of the dictatorship of mediality. A stereotype, therefore, is a process of simplyfing a dynamic complexity into rigid images. This schematization of reality, characteristics of the digital, has various consequence. In one hand, it simplies and accelerates the process, but a society radically founded on stereotypes does not achieve a better understanding of reality, rather its parallelization. Stereotypes becomes the form of thought proper to those subjected to the dictatorship of Das Man, which derives its strength not from its grounding, rather from its massive diffusion. It's a thought expressed in the stable and rigid form of what has already been thought, therefore more easily classified. The net functions by reducing everything into data, so translating all that exist into a rigid and schematized form. Stereotypes reveals trends, and

within it is contained both the way the net knows us as a mere set of data, and the way we come to know through the net. In both cases, it allows to grasp only the average form.

In the constant and uncritical repetition of what has already been said and heard, stereotypes allows prediction. Platforms, in order to host us, require us to reduce our existence that characterize us in the rigid form of a profile. Everything that authentically exists, and does not conform to the flatform of data, becomes irrelevant. These stereotypes operate at deep level, modifying the relation that we engage with others.

Our way of perceiving identity and alterity, because of their intrinsically connected nature, cannot be treated separately, nor can ignore the distortion of time and space produced by the net. Community rests upon those elements that the net tends to eliminate: duration and proximity to the other. In this sense, we may distinguish a community from a society and from the mass. These are different forms of human aggregation. Community comes from "cum-munias", where "munias" are the gifts. A society that is founded on the circulation of the gifts, relying on the paradigm of gratuity. Here, the identity is formed through a sense of belonging to others, rooted in family, friendship. Differently, a society is held together not primarily by the gift, but by interest. The center of gravity shifts from the community to the individual, pursuing ends and goals that require aggregation according to shared ?, like when we go to work, etc. Society is thus a form of human aggregation that can survive even in the absence of strong emotional bonds, established in communities.

A mass is where the individual disappears into the indistinction of identity. The individual becomes a number, and a large number of individuals act as a single entity. The mass forms and dissolves as soon as the reason for its formation disappears, like a strike taking place.

Digital communities cannot be reduced to any of these three forms. Even if they get the name from the "community", they will be more appropriately described as digital swarms, unable to rely on meaningful shared relations, they're held together by the fragile bond of preferences. Desire and preferences shape our digital world, that appears thanks to the constant typing on screens, as constructed around our needs and desires. Through the utilization of our device, we might cultivate the illusion of escaping the throwness. To be on the net also means attempting to eliminate that negativity that arises from being in contact with the world and others. This removal of negativity has profound implication from the relation between ourselves and the others. On the net, others become any other. In their physical absence and virtual presence I encounter only a projection

of the other, a performance of his identity. This form of alterity does not touch me, as distance protects me from this possibility. What alters me is what permutes my structure and transforms it. In connection, the presence of the other does not disappear, but is dramatically transformed. The others I encounter on the net are just a profile, and the screens shield people from the negativity of the opposition of the real (?). The identity as we know it is not something given to us at birth, rather something we keep constructing with and in opposition to others, not only through consensus, but also through dissent. To build a net is to be shielded and protected from others' body and gaze. We remain in control whether to continue the dialogue or dismiss it. Platforms do the same with us. Resistance is what allows our muscles to strengthen and grow, it's resistance that tests us. An opposite force is necessary to develop properly. Without this, muscles do not grow, but fatten. Muscles support movement and dynamism, while fat leads to stagnation. The flattening effect resulting from inhabiting a digital world, the other is replaced by the sameness. In this implementation of similarity, where every dimension is removed, identity proliferates in the form of ?. Others distract me, imprinting an experience upon me. The identical does not problematize me, it's just a mirror reflecting without generating any genuine reflection. Apparently, the possibility to remain hidden behind a screen should lead to a reduction of conflict, therefore expose us to less discomfort, but we can observe the opposite taking place. The necessity to perform our identity ignites, our propensity for commensurate comparison. While we are encouraged to become more transparent, this behaviour also exposes us to the phenomenon of online hating, a reaction implemented by the ego denied of speaking, a subject who can be silenced by algorithms, without knowing why. We can observe that we can draw the distinction between one's opinion and identity, as online identity and opinion coincide, since there is no other existential sphere. We defend our opinions, otherwise also our identity would be in danger.

Dialogue and digital exchanges are different phenomena, as the former is not just about speaking and communicating something, but is based on the action of listening. Listening is important. If we think about listening in German, it's "hören", which means to hear, while "gehören" means to belong. What is a dialogue? Discourse becomes an ego chamber that is also an echo chamber. If the other is expelled, a void remains. The disappearing of the physical presence impels us to be online in a compulsive way. Existences are replicated on social platforms through filters. The idle talk of which Heidegger refers to as a mode of discourse, online flares up as threads. This noise of small chat, that on the net becomes a digital store of data, stifles the silent voice of *dasein* that calls him to become

authentic through the appropriation of his differences. To be identical is different from being equal, as in being identical we try to deny our difference, while in being equal we are equal but in the difference. If I exist authentically I can never find someone else who's identical to me. Within the absence of distance (that is not closeness, proximity), promoted by virtual reality, the consequences of medial exposure emerges. There is a specific term, given by "promethean shame", which is the sense of inadequacy that we feel towards what we create, creating perfect rules, still feeling imperfect. It's a shame that takes us when we're compared to our products. The other is apprehend solely as a bearer of silent gratification through likes. Following a profile in the network does not mean to have a follow in return, there is no listening and any form of belonging. Content is unidirectionally guided by those who produce the stories, while those who consume them vanish. Competition, with distant others, filtered and altered others, drives me in measuring myself against them, to intervene on the image I choose to expose. Digital pictures are not portrayed anymore, but they're products. Digital photography allows to expose ourselves to others in a filtered way, producing our image instead of capturing it. Through a work of manipulation of our images, we return an image that is beyond and outside reality. The possibility of manipulating images leads to believe that freedom is increased by technological tools. In this way, we also see that in digital photography real reference is progressively eliminated. The photographed subject is also the photographer. In this connection, increases the detachment between the individual and digital profile.

Take the word "retractus". It means "something that is withdrawn". In order to paint ourselves, create our images, we need to withdraw from the gaze of others, so it's an inner process, while digital products (?) are made for the others.

Digital network like (?) the amphitheatral structure, in general based for the conventional mass media. When we turn on TV, we can see that it's focused on issues of general and social relevance. The new media, instead, are made of centripetal forces, with the spectator being at the center, addressing its attention towards what interests him. In the digital media, the public sphere breaks and fragments into a volatilized swarm, drawn by personal interests.

This era takes the name of "infotainment", mixing up different spheres in a blurry and confusing of these two.